



Building the Vision for Your Institute

The possibilities are endless for an institute that wants to embrace technology. Networked video surveillance, laptops with wireless Internet access stored on a cart and wheeled from classroom to classroom, emergency number access in every classroom and common areas, video conferencing with students all over the world and communicating with all students, parents and teachers over the Internet, just to name a few. And this is only the beginning

Lokesh Mehra

Networking technology can take you far beyond information transfer and Internet access, into an environment where data, video and voice all run on one network, one single infrastructure. And because the network is based on the Internet Protocol (IP) standard, you are already in a position to take advantage of new technologies as they arise.

Converged networks can be built one piece at a time, so you can affordably expand your network. And because the specific technologies are modular, and can be integrated to work with each other, you will be on your way to building the right network that will take care of your institute's needs for years to come. Here is a glimpse of what IP-based, converged networks can do.

Safer campus, safer students with IP video surveillance

Deans and principals across the country are being held accountable for physical security, now more than ever. Most institutes have a security solution in place, and are re-evaluating current solutions to see whether they are robust enough to handle new requirements. By integrating a surveillance system with the network, institutes gain greater security and realise savings. Here's how

it works.

IP video cameras, just like legacy cameras, are placed in common areas such as hallways, cafeterias, parking lots, hostels and other key locations throughout the institute campus. These cameras are connected to the network, and the video from these cameras can then be observed by authorised personnel who

are network users. Software for controlling the cameras, viewing the video and searching the archives, and hardware to store all the captured video on, are also part of this solution.

Via a secure virtual private network (VPN) technology, administrators can keep an eye on the campus anytime and



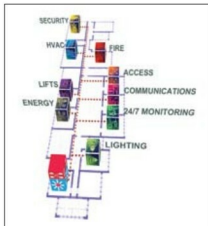
Lokesh Mehra, regional manager-corporate responsibility, South Asia, Cisco Systems

from anywhere. The VPN enables secure remote access to live or archived video for administrators connected to the institute's network. In addition, the local police department can be alerted by alarm, and using their Internet connection and VPN technology, can see the event happening from a PC at the station. Dispatchers and police officers can then act

in the most effective way possible.

Deans and administrators who use IP video surveillance believe that it is a powerful deterrent for theft and vandalism, and because of their ability to see an event live, from wherever they are, it will also prove invaluable if a violent emergency situation occurs within their schools, especially the raging incident spurts we have seen in the recent past.

Once an IP video surveillance system is implemented, the opportunity to integrate it with other IP technologies exists. For example, if an institute installs IP phones in every classroom, they can work with the security system and provide additional coverage. In this scenario, if an emergency occurs in class, a teacher/faculty could enter a code that would serve as a panic button, and security stations or campus police would be notified and dispatched immediately.



Security networking